

Short Polling

Request is taking a while, I'll check with you later

Where request/response isn't ideal

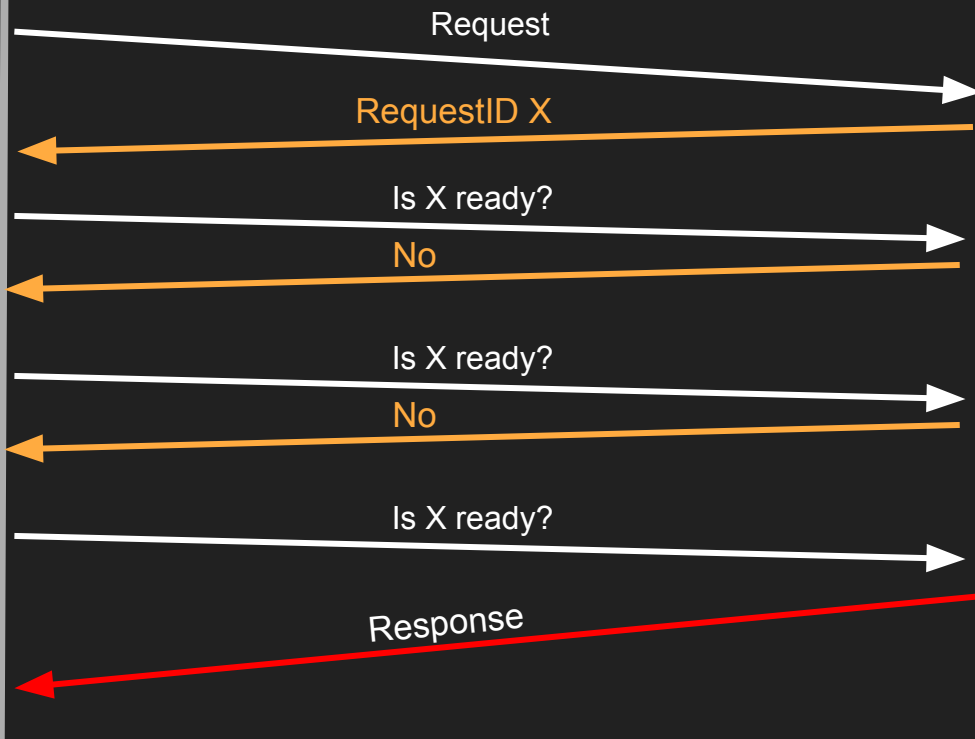
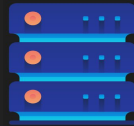
- A request takes long time to process
 - Upload a youtube video
- The backend want to sends notification
 - A user just logged in
- Polling is a good communication style

What is Short Polling?

- Client sends a request
- Server responds immediately with a handle
- Server continues to process the request
- Client uses that handle to check for status
- Multiple “short” request response as polls



Short Polling



Short Polling Pros and Cons

- Pros
 - Simple
 - Good for long running requests
 - Client can disconnect
- Cons
 - Too chatty
 - Network bandwidth
 - Wasted Backend resources

Demo Job Status

Check if a job is done with progress

Long Polling

Request is taking long, I'll check with you later
But talk to me only when it's ready

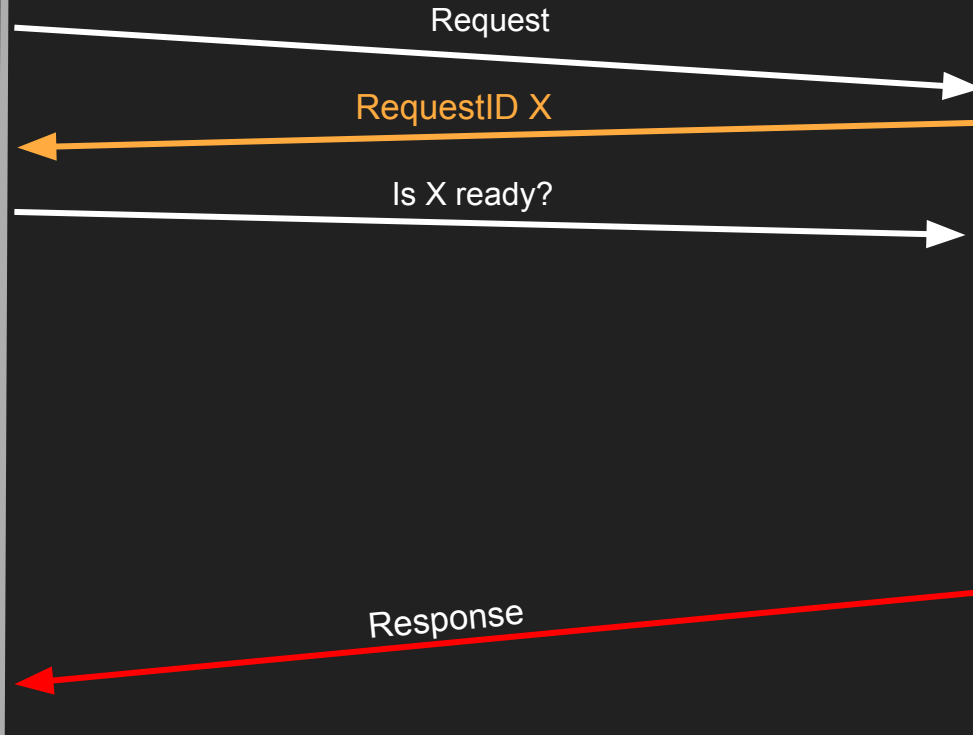
Where request/response & polling isn't ideal

- A request takes long time to process
 - Upload a youtube video
- The backend want to sends notification
 - A user just logged in
- Short Polling is a good but chatty
- Meet Long polling (Kafka uses it)

What is Long Polling?

- Client sends a request
- Server responds immediately with a handle
- Server continues to process the request
- Client uses that handle to check for status
- Server DOES not reply until it has the response
- So we got a handle, we can disconnect and we are less chatty
- Some variation has timeouts too

Long Polling



Long Polling Pros and Cons

- Pros
 - Less chatty and backend friendly
 - Client can still disconnect
- Cons
 - Not real time